

DC Scattering time in graphene from mobility measurements

We use the mobility measurements in Electric Field Effect in Atomically Thin Carbon Films

([https://www.science.org/doi/full/10.1126/science.1102896?](https://www.science.org/doi/full/10.1126/science.1102896?casa_token=UF3_Ns1F8TYAAAAA%3ADXkGRq7yLL5srhyEJP2sg8aRSca13Gw0pRpcA0be1aeJdm3ui6_be3NuLJQqV-3OE72IC0ZGvbVWmTQ4)

[casa_token=UF3_Ns1F8TYAAAAA%3ADXkGRq7yLL5srhyEJP2sg8aRSca13Gw0pRpcA0be1aeJdm3ui6_be3NuLJQqV-3OE72IC0ZGvbVWmTQ4](https://www.science.org/doi/full/10.1126/science.1102896?casa_token=UF3_Ns1F8TYAAAAA%3ADXkGRq7yLL5srhyEJP2sg8aRSca13Gw0pRpcA0be1aeJdm3ui6_be3NuLJQqV-3OE72IC0ZGvbVWmTQ4)), in order to find the DC scattering time in graphene. From the

paper cited above, we know that the mobility, μ and the DC conductivity, σ are related as follows:

$$\sigma = \lim_{\omega \rightarrow 0} \frac{ie^2 E_F}{\pi \hbar^2 (\omega + i/\tau)} = \frac{e^2 E_F \tau}{\pi \hbar^2} = ne\mu$$

Furthermore, we note that we have $n = g_s g_v \pi k_F^2 / (4\pi^2)$, where $g_s = g_v = 2$ are the spin and valley degeneracies, respectively. Using the linear dispersion of graphene, i.e. $E_F = \hbar v_F k_F$, we may write the electronic density in terms of the Fermi energy as follows:

$$n = E_F^2 / (\hbar^2 v_F^2 \pi) \leftrightarrow E_F = \hbar v_F \sqrt{\pi n}$$

Therefore, writing the decay time in terms of the electronic density gives us:

$$\tau = \pi \hbar^2 n \mu / e E_F = \hbar \sqrt{\pi n} \mu / e v_F,$$

which is the result cited in Plasmonics in graphene at infrared frequencies

([https://journals.aps.org/prb/pdf/10.1103/PhysRevB.80.245435?](https://journals.aps.org/prb/pdf/10.1103/PhysRevB.80.245435?casa_token=QoZK8jL_kglAAAAA%3A41U2yqebBFQC2mDR4Vxzy3WVE8xxu8OiAQx3W_DQPLobNfexjlxrSqt81ggHzFORM3JjJZmrSHre8St)

[casa_token=QoZK8jL_kglAAAAA%3A41U2yqebBFQC2mDR4Vxzy3WVE8xxu8OiAQx3W_DQPLobNfexjlxrSqt81ggHzFORM3JjJZmrSHre8St](https://journals.aps.org/prb/pdf/10.1103/PhysRevB.80.245435?casa_token=QoZK8jL_kglAAAAA%3A41U2yqebBFQC2mDR4Vxzy3WVE8xxu8OiAQx3W_DQPLobNfexjlxrSqt81ggHzFORM3JjJZmrSHre8St)). We now use the values $n = 10^{13}/\text{cm}^2$ and

$\mu = 10,000 \text{ cm}^2/(\text{Volt} \times \text{s})$, $v_F = 10^8 \text{ cm/s}$, we obtain:

$$\begin{aligned} \tau &= 1.05 \times 10^{-34} \text{ Joules} \times \text{s} \sqrt{\pi 10^{13}} \times 10000 / (1.6 \times 10^{-19} \text{ Joules} \times 10^8) = \\ &= 1.05 \times 10^{-13} \text{ Joules} \times \text{s} \sqrt{\pi 10} / (1.6 \times \text{Joules}) = 3.7 \times 10^{-13} \text{ s} \end{aligned}$$

This is not quite 6.4×10^{-13} seconds as cited in the Soljagic paper. However, in that case, they took $n = 3 \times 10^{13}/\text{cm}^2$, so we need to multiply the answer above by $\sqrt{3}$, which give 6.37×10^{-13} seconds, as desired.